Language-Gated GR-ConvNet: Steering a Lightweight Grasp Detector with CLIP Patch–Text Similarity

Minh-Ngoc Luong
Hanoi University of Science and Technology
ngoclm004@gmail.com

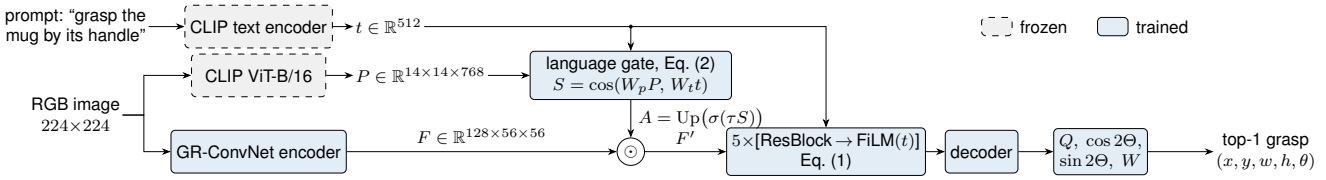


Figure 1. **Language-Gated GR-ConvNet.** Blue: trained (2.9M parameters); CLIP [5]: frozen. The prompt enters through a spatial gate A and through FiLM [4] after every residual block. C0 replaces $W_t t$ by a learned vector q.

Abstract

Language-driven grasp detection requires placing a grasp on the object part named by a free-form prompt. We steer GR-ConvNet, a lightweight grasp network, with FiLM and a language gate*, a spatial map of cosine similarities between frozen CLIP patch tokens and the prompt embedding. Trained on 36k Grasp-Anything++ images, the model reaches 68.6% seen and 57.8% unseen success (two-seed mean) on the annotated official test split. A gate that cannot read the prompt loses 9.9 unseen points, so about half of the gain over FiLM comes from prompt-dependent gating rather than stronger visual features. Code: https://github.com/Ngoc-LM/language-gated-grasp.*

1. Introduction

A parallel-jaw grasp is a rotated rectangle $g = (x, y, w, h, \theta)$: centre, opening, jaw size and angle [1]. Language-driven grasp detection conditions g on a prompt such as "grasp the knife by its handle", so the model must first find *which* part is meant. Grasp-Anything++ [7] provides 1M images, over 10M such prompts and a diffusion model, LGD; we instead steer a small single-pass grasp CNN. Our contributions are (i) a *language gate* that re-weights GR-ConvNet [2] features by CLIP [5] patch–text similarity, adding 0.33M parameters (Fig. 1); (ii) a controlled ablation (text-free gate, second seed) that separates CLIP visual features from prompt-dependent gating; and (iii) a leakage-controlled evaluation with open code.

2. Related Work

Generative grasp CNNs [2, 3] regress dense grasp maps and decode the best pixel. CLIPort [6] fuses CLIP features into "what/where" streams for manipulation. LGD [7] denoises grasps under text guidance. MaskCLIP [8] localises named objects with dense CLIP features; our gate instead learns lightweight projections that align CLIP patch tokens with the prompt.

3. Method

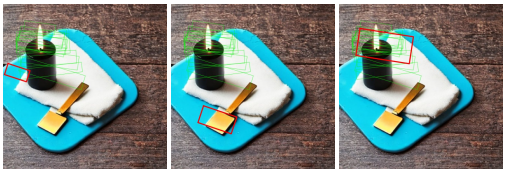
Grasp maps. As in [2], the network predicts four 224×224 maps: quality Q, $\cos 2\Theta$, $\sin 2\Theta$ and opening W. The angle is doubled because a grasp is unchanged by a 180° rotation. Targets fill each ground-truth rectangle shortened to the central third of its opening. The smoothed maps are read at $\arg\max Q$, with $\theta = \frac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{atan2}(\sin 2\Theta, \cos 2\Theta)$ and $h = w/2$.

FiLM. The encoder maps the image to $F \in \mathbb{R}^{128\times56\times56}$, followed by five residual blocks and a decoder. With t the normalised CLIP text embedding, each residual block k is followed by

$$F \leftarrow \big(1 + \Delta\gamma_k(t)\big) \odot F + \beta_k(t), \tag{1}$$

where $\Delta\gamma_k, \beta_k \in \mathbb{R}^{128}$ come from a zero-initialised linear layer, so each FiLM layer is the identity at initialisation.

Language gate (proposed). FiLM applies the same channel modulation at every pixel, so it can favour one object among several only indirectly. We therefore compare the 14×14 post-LayerNorm patch tokens P of a frozen CLIP



B (FiLM) ✗ C0 (text-free gate) ✗ C (ours) ✓

Figure 2. **Unseen prompt** "Fetch candle by its flame" (green: GT; red: prediction): B misses, C0 picks a distractor, C succeeds. On "lamp by its stand", C0 succeeds and C fails.

	Model	Seen	Unseen	H	ms
A	GR-ConvNet (no text)	27.3	27.8	27.5	4.3
B	+ FiLM(t)	52.0	40.1	45.3	12.3
C0	B + text-free CLIP gate	62.8	47.9	54.4	18.2
C	B + language gate (**ours**)	$68.6_{\pm 0.5}$	$57.8_{\pm 1.9}$	$62.8_{\pm 1.3}$	18.9
D	C + gate supervision	70.9	57.7	63.6	18.8
	GR-ConvNet + CLIP†	37	18	24	–
	LGD† [7]	48	42	45	–

Table 1. **Success rate (%) on the test split.** C: mean±half-range (two seeds); others: one seed. ms: batch-1 end-to-end T4 latency incl. CLIP. 95% CIs ≈ ± 2.5 (seen), ±3.9 (unseen). †From [7], full training set; not comparable.

ViT-B/16 with the prompt and gate the encoder output:

$$S_{ij} = \cos(W_p\, p_{ij},\, W_t\, t), \qquad A = \mathrm{Up}_{56}\big(\sigma(\tau S)\big), \qquad F' = F \odot (1 + A), \tag{2}$$

with learned $W_p \in \mathbb{R}^{256\times 768}$, $W_t \in \mathbb{R}^{256\times 512}$ and temperature τ (initialised to 10). The residual form $1{+}A$ only amplifies prompt-matching regions. The **C0 control** replaces $W_t t$ with a learned vector q: its gate sees the same CLIP features but not the prompt (FiLM still receives t). **Loss:** Smooth-ℓ_1 summed over the four maps. Variant D adds $0.5\,\mathrm{BCE}(\tau S, M)$, M the pooled ground-truth Q mask.

4. Experiments

Protocol. We train on 35,964 Grasp-Anything++ scenes (183,559 prompt–grasp pairs) and validate on 734. We test on the official LGD split (the 70% most frequent LVIS categories are *seen*), restricted to its annotated pairs: 1,376 seen and 601 unseen (727 of 803 object keys). Test scenes and training pairs naming unseen test objects are excluded from training. A top-1 grasp is correct if its IoU exceeds 0.25 and its angle error is below 30° for some ground-truth grasp of the prompted part. H is the harmonic mean of seen and unseen success. Decoding ground-truth maps scores 97.5% (the encoding's ceiling). All models use AdamW (lr 10^{-3}, cosine), batch 32, 6 epochs, no augmentation and one Kaggle T4 (2.5–2.7 h), with checkpoints selected on 1,000 validation pairs.

Results. Tab. 1 is a chain of controlled steps. Model A ignores the prompt, so seen ≈ unseen. FiLM (B) adds 17.8 points of H, and CLIP features behind a text-free gate (C0) add 9.1. Letting the gate read the prompt (C) adds 8.4 more, with a larger gain on unseen (+9.9) than seen (+5.9) objects (Fig. 2). This gap exceeds C's seed range (3.8) and the 95% interval of a two-proportion difference (±5.6). Gate supervision (D) adds 2.2 seen points (within binomial noise) and leaves unseen and H unchanged; we keep C.

Cost and limitations. C also runs a frozen 149M-parameter CLIP; with the prompt embedding cached, a frame takes 12.5 ms. We use 3.6% of the images, one seed for most variants and only annotated test pairs, so absolute numbers are not comparable to [7].

5. Conclusion

A frozen-CLIP patch–text gate lifts a lightweight grasp CNN from 27.5 to 62.8 H, half of the gain over FiLM coming from prompt-dependent gating.

References

[1] Yun Jiang, Stephen Moseson, and Ashutosh Saxena. Efficient grasping from RGBD images: Learning using a new rectangle representation. In *2011 IEEE International conference on robotics and automation*, pages 3304–3311. IEEE, 2011.

[2] Sulabh Kumra, Shirin Joshi, and Ferat Sahin. Antipodal robotic grasping using generative residual convolutional neural network. In *2020 IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, pages 9626–9633. IEEE, 2020.

[3] Douglas Morrison, Peter Corke, and Jürgen Leitner. Closing the loop for robotic grasping: A real-time, generative grasp synthesis approach. *arXiv preprint arXiv:1804.05172*, 2018.

[4] Ethan Perez, Florian Strub, Harm De Vries, Vincent Dumoulin, and Aaron Courville. FiLM: Visual reasoning with a general conditioning layer. In *Proceedings of the AAAI conference on artificial intelligence*, 2018.

[5] Alec Radford, Jong Wook Kim, Chris Hallacy, Aditya Ramesh, Gabriel Goh, Sandhini Agarwal, Girish Sastry, Amanda Askell, Pamela Mishkin, Jack Clark, et al. Learning transferable visual models from natural language supervision. In *International conference on machine learning*, pages 8748–8763. PmLR, 2021.

[6] Mohit Shridhar, Lucas Manuelli, and Dieter Fox. CLIPort: What and where pathways for robotic manipulation. In *Conference on robot learning*, pages 894–906. pmlr, 2022.

[7] An Dinh Vuong, Minh Nhat Vu, Baoru Huang, Nghia Nguyen, Hieu Le, Thieu Vo, and Anh Nguyen. Language-driven grasp detection. In *2024 IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 17902–17912. IEEE, 2024.

[8] Chong Zhou, Chen Change Loy, and Bo Dai. Extract free dense labels from CLIP. In *European conference on computer vision*, pages 696–712. Springer Nature Switzerland, 2022.